

Smartphone photography has come of age

Die hard dSLR enthusiasts will probably scoff at the idea of using a smartphone as a primary camera; and for good reason. Smartphone cameras admittedly do have a few intrinsic weaknesses but they also have a lot of advantages – the biggest one being that your trusty smartphone is the one camera you have with you at all times. Smartphone cameras let budding photography hobbyists experience a freedom of movement which is unmatched by any other type of camera. Phones are easy to handle, quick, and most importantly discreet – pulling one out won't make people stop and stare. Besides, to burst the elitist bubble, the quality of smartphone cameras has increased dramatically over the years, giving rise to smartphone photography as a worldwide phenomenon. Consider the fact that on instagram alone around 50 million photos get uploaded each day. That's staggering by itself. Add to it facebook and hundreds of other photo sharing services and you have something mindboggling.

This social aspect of smartphone cameras is another advantage. Enthusiasts can click and share their creativity for instant feedback and fame. Also touching up images, adding filters and correction required computers earlier. Now all of that is possible with a few taps on your smartphone itself. This FastTrack will get you acquainted with not just that but tons of other helpful tips on understanding your camera's settings, composing a good shot, working with lighting conditions, and lists of apps that'll help enhance your camera's default functionality.

We start with exploring a bit of history on how and why smartphones have become a viable option for serious photography. Increase in sensor sizes, lens technology and other aspects are explained in the first chapter.